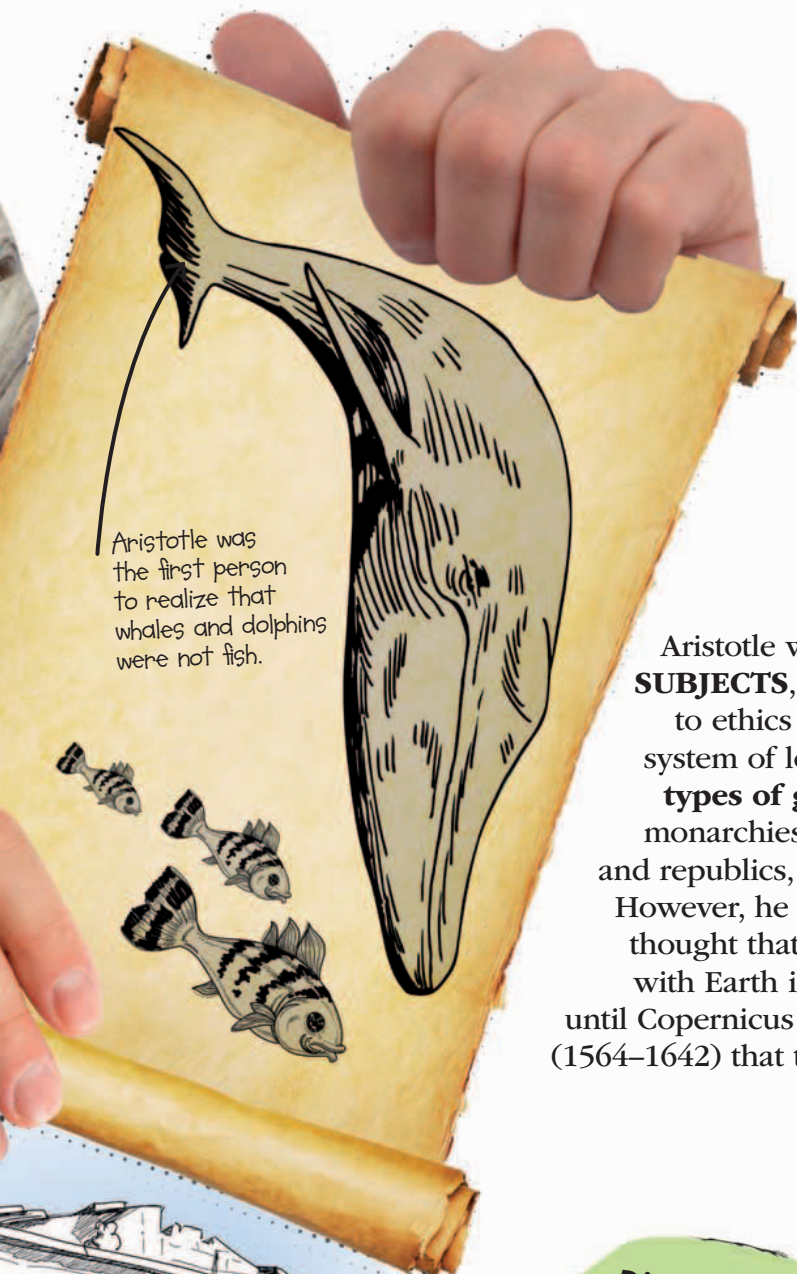




Aristotle was the first person to realize that whales and dolphins were not fish.



Searching for order

Aristotle used **Socrates's method of logic** to try and figure out how the world worked. He tried to **classify plants and animals** in a way that would make sense. For example, he grouped animals that seemed similar into two groups: those with red blood and those without red blood. He then divided those groups into **SPECIES**.

Aristotle stuttered when he spoke

Great thinker

Aristotle wrote about **DIFFERENT SUBJECTS**, from poetry and theater, to ethics and politics. He used his system of logic to organize different **types of governments**, classifying monarchies, tyrannies, democracies, and republics, which we still use today. However, he also **made mistakes**. He thought that the Universe is a sphere with Earth in its center, and it wasn't until Copernicus (1473–1543) and Galileo (1564–1642) that this idea was questioned.



This picture by Galileo in 1635 shows Aristotle (left) discussing astronomy with Ptolemy (90–160 CE) in the center and Copernicus (right).

Did you know?

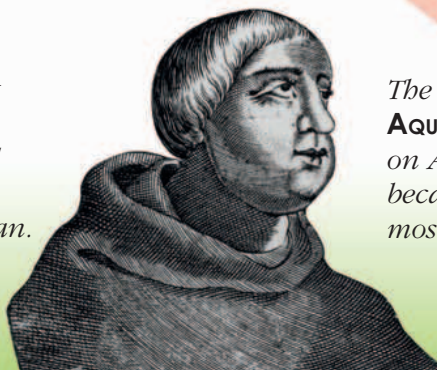
Aristotle is remembered as a great thinker in many areas, but he didn't think much of women. He branded them second-class citizens, unfit for any legal or political rights.

Pioneer of science

Aristotle wrote more than 200 books. He pioneered the use of logic instead of mysticism, and founded the science of zoology. He also paved the way to the creation of the modern scientific method, which emphasizes observation and experimentation.



At a time when Aristotle was out of favor among Islamic thinkers, **AVERROES** (1126–1198) defended Aristotle's work and became a great scientist and mathematician.



The Italian priest **THOMAS AQUINAS** (1225–1274) built on Aristotle's ideas, and became one of the West's most influential philosophers.